

Internal Study Guide — Faculty & UGCC

Reviewer Reference

BSCND Sports Medicine Minor (SPMD 301–304) & Sports & Fitness Coaching Concentration (SPMD 305–308)
Khalifa University · College of Medicine and Health Sciences · May 2026 · Restricted Circulation

Inferred Content Disclosure: SPMD 305–308 syllabi have not been formally authored. Course structures, CLOs, PLO mappings, and ICREPs alignments are inferred from Dr. Habiba Alsafar's correspondence (May 2026), the proposed course table (Kartik Rangaraj/Sara Almessabi), published ICREPs Level 3 PT competency units, and REPs UAE registration requirements. All SPMD 305–308 content marked **INFERRED** must be reviewed and validated by SPMD faculty before any UGCC or ADEK submission. SPMD 301–304 are based on approved/consolidated syllabi **REVIEWED**.

1. KU Undergraduate Framework Placement — SPMD Courses

The KU undergraduate framework places courses in Year 3 (300-level) and Year 4 (400-level). All eight SPMD courses are correctly classified within this framework:

Code	Title	Credits	YR/ Sem	Track	Status	Format
SPMD 301	Foundations of Sports Medicine	3	Y3 Fall	Minor	REVIEWED	3L / 0Lab
SPMD 302	Exercise Physiology	3	Y3 Spring	Minor	REVIEWED	3L / 0Lab
SPMD 303	Injury Prevention & Rehabilitation	3	Y3 Spring	Minor	REVIEWED	3L / 0Lab
SPMD 304	Performance Assessment & Technology	3	Y4 Fall	Minor	REVIEWED	2L / 1Lab
SPMD 305	Personal Training & Exercise	3	Y3 Fall	Concentration	INFERRED	2L / 1Lab

	Programme Design					
SPMD 306	Group Fitness, Stretching & Conditioning Instruction	3	Y3 Spring	Concentration	INFERRED	1L / 2Lab
SPMD 307	Fitness Coaching, Behaviour Change & Business of Fitness	3	Y4 Fall	Concentration	INFERRED	3L / 0Lab
SPMD 308	Fitness Coaching Practicum & REPs UAE Certification Capstone	3	Y4 Spring	Concentration	INFERRED	1L / 200 supervised hrs

Credit note: A known data-entry error in BSCND_KU_Mapping/_data.json lists SPMD 304 credits as 0. The correct value is 3 credits, confirmed from the SPMD 304 syllabus header. This error must be corrected in all program documentation before UGCC submission.

2. Prerequisite Logic and Sequencing

The prerequisite chain enforces progressive skill-building from foundational science through applied coaching practice:

Course	Prerequisite	Rationale
SPMD 301	BIOL 207: Human Physiology	Human physiology provides the anatomical and systems basis for sports medicine concepts
SPMD 302	BIOL 207: Human Physiology	Cellular and systems physiology underpins exercise bioenergetics and cardiorespiratory adaptation
SPMD 303	SPMD 301: Foundations of Sports Medicine	Injury prevention/rehab requires prior grounding in anatomy of movement, injury mechanisms, and tissue healing. Note: source docx typo BMED301 corrected to SPMD301.

SPMD 304	SPMD 302: Exercise Physiology	Performance assessment technology requires understanding physiological parameters being measured (VO ₂ , lactate, HRV). Note: source docx typo BMED302 corrected to SPMD302.
SPMD 305	SPMD 301: Foundations of Sports Medicine	Exercise programme design requires anatomical and biomechanical understanding from SPMD 301
SPMD 306	SPMD 302: Exercise Physiology	Group instruction requires physiological understanding of training adaptations and individual variation
SPMD 307	SPMD 305: Personal Training & Exercise Programme Design	Behaviour change and business modules build on applied exercise prescription experience from SPMD 305
SPMD 308	SPMD 306 + SPMD 307 (both)	Capstone practicum requires mastery of group instruction (SPMD 306) and professional practice/behaviour change (SPMD 307) before supervised placement hours begin

3. PLO-CLO Derivation Rationale

BSCND Program Learning Outcomes (PLOs) were mapped to SPMD courses to ensure coherence with the parent program's QFEmirates Level 6 learning outcomes:

PLO	Label	SPMD Courses	Derivation Logic
PLO1	Problem-Solving with Science	301, 302, 303, 304, 305, 307	Applied scientific analysis of movement, physiology, and evidence-based intervention — core to all sports science courses
PLO2	System / Program Design	301, 302, 303, 304, 305, 306, 308	Programme, prevention, and performance system design; directly realized in SPMD 305 and SPMD 308 applied outputs
PLO3	Experimentation & Data Analysis	302, 304, 305	Quantitative assessment (VO ₂ max, force platforms, fitness metrics) forms the scientific substrate of coaching decisions
PLO4			

	Communication & Collaborative Practice	301, 303, 306, 307, 308	Interprofessional collaboration, client communication, instructional delivery, and reflective practice
PLO5	Ethics & Professional Responsibility	306, 307, 308	UAE regulatory compliance, scope of practice, professional ethics, and MoHRE/DED/REPs UAE requirements

4. ICREPs Level 3 PT Competency Alignment (SPMD 305-308) **INFERRED**

The four Concentration courses were designed to collectively address all ICREPs Level 3 Personal Trainer competency units required for REPs UAE registration:

ICREPs L3 PT Unit	SPMD Course	CLO Mapping
Apply Principles of Training	SPMD 305	CLO1 (FITT-VP, periodization), CLO4 (programme adjustment)
Programme Design for General Population	SPMD 305	CLO1, CLO2 (needs analysis), CLO5 (nutrition integration)
Group Fitness Instructor Competencies (ICREPs L2/3 GFI)	SPMD 306	CLO1, CLO2, CLO3, CLO5 (REPs UAE GFI competencies)
Client Consultation & Behaviour Change	SPMD 307	CLO1 (TTM, MI, SDT), CLO2 (UAE regulatory environment)
Professional Practice (Scope + Ethics + Business)	SPMD 307	CLO3 (ethics/liability), CLO4 (business model), CLO5 (dual scope)
Practical Coaching Hours (200 hrs supervised)	SPMD 308	CLO1 (200 hrs delivery), CLO3 (REPs UAE portfolio)
First Aid / CPR / AED Certification	SPMD 308	CLO2 (embedded external certification)

5. SPMD 305-308 Inferred-Content Disclaimer (Full)

UGCC reviewers must understand the provenance of SPMD 305-308 content before deliberation:

- **Source of course titles and structures:** Dr. Habiba Alsafar's May 14, 2026 email forwarding a proposed table from Dr. Carlo Raj, confirmed in follow-up from Kartik Rangaraj (Period Director, Medical Education). These courses were

described as "newly proposed additions under Dr. Kinda's guidance" — not formally reviewed by any committee as of May 2026.

- **Source of CLOs:** Inferred by pipeline agents from (a) ICREPs Level 3 PT published competency units, (b) REPs UAE registration requirements at repsuae.com, (c) Physical Manager Program Plan PPTX (Cseh 2018) module mapping, and (d) the gap analysis in Integration_Deliverables/_analysis.json.
- **Source of PLO and KU ILO mappings:** Derived by applying standard KU UGCC alignment methodology to inferred CLOs. Not validated by BSCND program faculty or CMHS College Council.
- **What faculty must do before UGCC submission:** Author full syllabi using KU Course Syllabus Template (December 2025 version); validate CLOs against actual course content; confirm ICREPs alignment with a REPs UAE liaison contact; obtain CMHS College Council endorsement.

6. FAQ for UGCC Committee Deliberation

Q1: Why are SPMD 301-304 and SPMD 305-308 submitted together as a bundled UGCC packet?

The Concentration (305-308) builds directly on the Minor (301-304) through the prerequisite chain. Separating the submissions creates risk of orphaned prerequisites and forces a second UGCC review cycle. Bundling also allows the committee to evaluate the complete dual-credential pathway in a single deliberation, reducing administrative overhead for the Q4 2026 ADEK submission deadline.

Q2: SPMD 303 and SPMD 304 source syllabi contain "BMED 301/302" as prerequisite codes. Is this an error?

Yes — confirmed data-entry errors. The prerequisites should read SPMD 301 (for SPMD 303) and SPMD 302 (for SPMD 304). These typos are documented in the pipeline's known_data_issues log and must be corrected in the UGCC submission packet before filing.

Q3: Kinda Khalaf mentioned approximately 18 credits for a "strengthened minor." How does this relate to the current 12-credit proposal?

This discrepancy is unresolved as of May 2026 and requires a decision by Dr. Carlo Raj before UGCC submission. The current pipeline uses Option A (12-credit Concentration, total 124→136 credits). If the 18-credit option is preferred, an alternative track design must be developed. UGCC reviewers should note this as a pending design decision.

Q4: Does completion of SPMD 305-308 guarantee REPs UAE registration for graduates?

Not automatically. REPs UAE registration requires (1) an ICREPs-accredited Level 3 PT qualification — which the SPMD Concentration must formally obtain through ICREPs accreditation, (2) a current First Aid/CPR certificate (embedded in SPMD 308), and (3) documented practical hours (200 hrs in SPMD 308). KU must obtain a formal alignment/accreditation letter from REPs UAE confirming SPMD 305–308 meets ICREPs Level 3 PT standards. This is scheduled as a Q3 2027 gate.

Q5: How does SPMD 304 differ from SPMD 305 for the purposes of QFEmirates Level 6 skills?

SPMD 304 (Performance Assessment & Technology) is framed around measuring and monitoring athlete performance using laboratory and wearable technology — it is assessment-oriented and athlete-facing. SPMD 305 (Personal Training & Exercise Programme Design) is prescription-oriented and general-population/client-facing. SPMD 304 belongs to the Minor; SPMD 305 belongs to the Concentration. They are complementary but non-redundant.

Q6: What are the lab facility requirements for SPMD 305, 306, and 308?

SPMD 305 (1 lab/wk, 150 min): requires resistance training equipment, cardiovascular machines, functional training tools. SPMD 306 (2 lab/wk, 300 min): requires group exercise studio with sound system, stretching area, conditioning equipment. SPMD 308 (200 supervised hours): requires practicum placement MoUs with REPs-affiliated Abu Dhabi health clubs (Fitness First, Gold's Gym, NAS Sports Complex Abu Dhabi). Current KU CMHS facilities and practicum placement capacity must be confirmed before UGCC submission.

7. KU ILO Coverage Across SPMD Courses

KU's fifteen Institutional Learning Outcomes (ILOs) provide the institutional framework for quality assurance. The table below maps SPMD courses to the KU ILOs they address, supporting UGCC reviewers in validating that the SPMD tracks contribute meaningfully to KU's graduate profile:

KU ILO	Description (summary)	SPMD Courses
ILO1	Breadth of knowledge across disciplines	SPMD 301
ILO2	Apply scientific method	SPMD 302, 304, 305
ILO3	Critical thinking and problem analysis	SPMD 301, 302, 303, 305
ILO5	Understanding of sustainability / societal impact	SPMD 307
ILO6	Effective communication (written/oral)	SPMD 301, 306, 307, 308

ILO7	Digital literacy and technology use	SPMD 304
ILO8	Quantitative reasoning and data interpretation	SPMD 302, 304
ILO9	Lifelong learning and professional development	SPMD 302, 303, 305, 306, 307
ILO10	Innovation and creative problem solving	SPMD 304, 305
ILO11	Research skills	SPMD 308
ILO12	Teamwork and collaboration	SPMD 303, 306, 308
ILO14	Ethics, professionalism, and social responsibility	SPMD 306, 307, 308
ILO15	Self-management and leadership	SPMD 308

8. Course-Level Learning Environment Requirements

Faculty and the UGCC must confirm that the following physical learning environment requirements can be met before the SPMD courses go live in Fall 2027:

Course	Room Type	Equipment Required	Status
SPMD 301	Lecture theatre / seminar room	Standard AV; anatomical models optional	Standard KU provision — no special requirements
SPMD 302	Lecture theatre	Standard AV; access to spirometry/VO2max equipment desirable but not mandatory for 3L/0Lab format	Lecture-only — standard provision
SPMD 303	Lecture theatre	Standard AV; movement assessment tools (goniometers, FMS kit) desirable	Lecture-only — standard provision
SPMD 304	Sports science laboratory	Force platforms, motion capture system or equivalent, heart rate monitors, GPS trackers, body composition analyser	REQUIRES CONFIRMATION: laboratory availability and equipment procurement must be verified before UGCC submission
		Resistance training equipment (barbells,	REQUIRES CONFIRMATION: KU CMHS fitness facility

SPMD 305	Fitness laboratory / gym	dumbbells, cable machines), cardiovascular machines (treadmills, bikes, rowers), functional training tools	capacity for class instruction use
SPMD 306	Group exercise studio	Sound system, open floor space, mats, resistance bands, steps, group exercise props	REQUIRES CONFIRMATION: dedicated group exercise studio required; 300 min/ week lab time is substantial
SPMD 307	Lecture theatre / seminar room	Standard AV; case study materials; guest speaker capacity for UAE industry practitioners	Standard provision — no special requirements
SPMD 308	External placement + weekly seminar room	200 supervised hours at REPs-affiliated health clubs; KU seminar room for weekly reflection sessions; CPR/AED manikins for embedded certification	CRITICAL: MoUs with Fitness First UAE, Gold's Gym, NAS Sports Complex Abu Dhabi must be executed by Q1 2027

9. Textbook and Resource Recommendations for SPMD 305-308

The following textbooks are recommended for the as-yet-unAuthored SPMD 305-308 syllabi, based on ICREPs Level 3 PT standard reading lists and the BSCND programme's existing textbook selection criteria (current editions, peer-reviewed, QFEmirates Level 6 appropriate):

Course	Recommended Primary Textbook	Rationale
SPMD 305	Baechle, T. R., & Earle, R. W. (Eds.). (2008). Essentials of Strength Training and Conditioning (3rd or 4th ed.). Human Kinetics. AND American College of Sports Medicine. (2022). ACSM's Guidelines for Exercise Testing and Prescription (11th ed.). Wolters Kluwer.	NSCA CSCS text provides periodization and programme design; ACSM Guidelines provides general-population prescription standards aligned with ICREPs L3 PT
SPMD 306	Francis, L. (2020). Group Fitness Instructor Manual. American Council on Exercise (ACE).	Industry-standard group fitness instruction text; maps to REPs UAE GFI competencies and ACE GFI certification requirements

SPMD 307	Rollnick, S., Miller, W. R., & Butler, C. C. (2008). <i>Motivational Interviewing in Health Care</i> . Guilford Press. AND Prochaska, J. O., & Norcross, J. C. (2018). <i>Systems of Psychotherapy: A Transtheoretical Analysis</i> (9th ed.). Oxford University Press.	MI and TTM primary source texts for CLO1's behaviour-change theory module; both standard in coaching psychology curricula at QFEmirates L6
SPMD 308	No single primary text — practicum-based course. Portfolio assessment documentation: REPs UAE Practical Hours Log template; KU Reflective Practice Framework; CPR/AED certification materials from Heart & Stroke Foundation or UAE Red Crescent.	Practicum capstone assessed via portfolio, supervision logs, and external certification — not textbook-based

10. Assessment Strategy Overview (SPMD 305–308)

Pending formal syllabus authoring, the following assessment strategy is proposed based on ICREPs Level 3 PT competency requirements and UGCC standard assessment design principles:

Course	Proposed Assessment Mix	ICREPs Competency Evidence
SPMD 305	60% practical (in-lab programme delivery demonstration + client assessment simulation); 40% written (exercise prescription report with scientific justification)	Satisfies ICREPs L3 PT "Apply Principles of Training" practical evidence requirement
SPMD 306	80% practical (group fitness class delivery — observed and peer-assessed); 20% written (class design documentation)	Satisfies ICREPs L2/3 GFI observed teaching requirement
SPMD 307	50% case study report (client coaching plan); 30% role-play assessment (motivational interviewing); 20% business plan submission	Satisfies ICREPs L3 PT "Client Consultation" and "Professional Practice" evidence requirements
SPMD 308	Portfolio (60%): supervised hours log + supervisor evaluation forms + reflective journal; External certification (30%): CPR/AED pass/fail from accredited provider; Final presentation (10%): professional development goals	Directly assembles REPs UAE PT registration portfolio — the portfolio IS the assessment artefact

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305–308 content is inferred and requires faculty validation before any formal submission.